

2026 EDITION

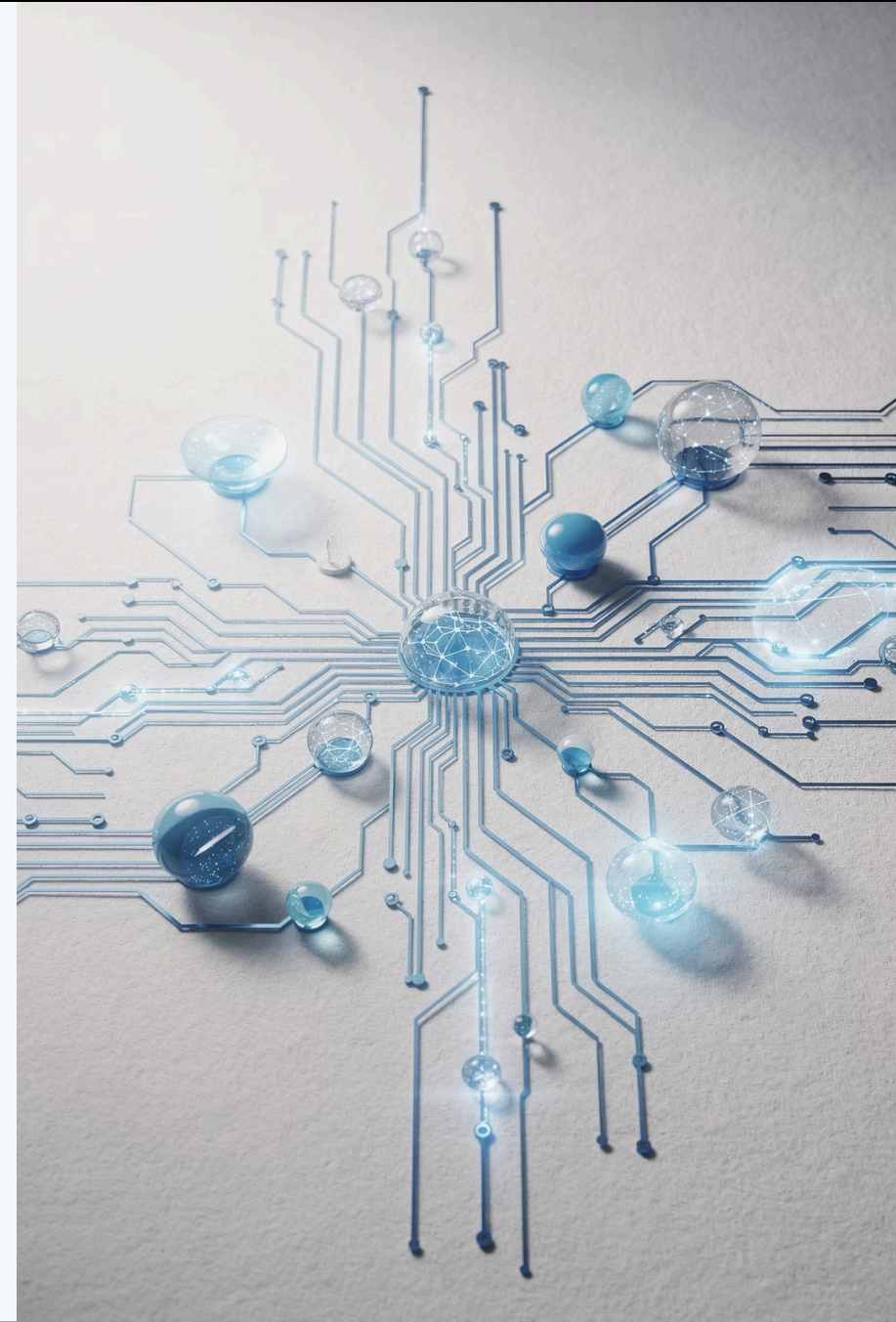
AI

Implementation

Playbook

A comprehensive, step-by-step guide for UK Small & Medium Enterprises ready to harness artificial intelligence — with real costs in sterling, expert guidance, and practical action at every stage.

[ACROSSAI.CO.UK](https://acrossai.co.uk)



The UK SME *AI Opportunity* — Why Act Now?

£94B

GDP Potential

Annual addition to UK GDP from just a 1% productivity uplift across SMEs, per the Government's SME Digital Adoption Taskforce

35%

Current Adoption

Only 35–39% of UK SMEs actively use AI tools, meaning the majority are leaving significant competitive advantage on the table

£69

Starter Monthly Cost

A practical AI starter suite can be implemented for approximately £69 per month — far less than most SMEs assume

27%+

Productivity Gains

SME productivity gains from AI implementation range from 27% to 133%, per University of St Andrews and the Department for Business & Trade

 **The Cost of Waiting:** Competitors who adopted AI in 2024 have spent 18+ months learning what works. That knowledge advantage compounds daily. The businesses that wait for perfect clarity rarely achieve it.



Why AI *Fails* for UK SMEs — and How to Avoid It

Understanding why AI projects fail is as important as knowing how to implement them. Up to 70% of SME AI initiatives are abandoned before reaching production. Here are the most common failure modes — and the fixes.

🚫 Poor Problem Definition

Teams buy tools before identifying the specific problem to solve. Fix: Start with a clear, measurable pain point with a financial cost attached.

🚫 Data Unreadiness

Poor data quality affects 67% of UK businesses. AI amplifies dysfunction, not fixes it. Fix: Audit and clean data before deploying any AI tool.

🚫 Enterprise-Mimicking

SMEs copy large-company approaches unsuited to their resource constraints. Fix: Start small, prove value, then scale — the phased approach consistently outperforms big-bang rollouts.

🚫 No Change Management

Less than 10% of budgets are allocated to training and adoption. Fix: Invest in people, not just technology. Successful companies allocate 70% of AI budgets to people and processes.

The *5-Phase* AI Implementation Roadmap

This playbook is structured around five proven phases, each building on the last. Do not skip phases — the order matters.



Timeframe: Most UK SMEs that follow this phased approach see measurable productivity gains within 90 days of starting Phase 3. Phases 1 and 2 typically take 2–4 weeks combined. The full roadmap to scale runs 6–12 months for most businesses.

Phase 1: *Diagnose & Define*

Weeks 1-2 | Cost: Free

The single most important phase. Do not start with AI strategy — start with a business problem. The majority of failed AI projects can be traced back to this phase being skipped or rushed.

1 Audit Your Operations

Review last month's operations. Note where tasks took longer than expected, where errors occurred, and which processes required the most chasing. Interview three people in customer-facing roles: what do they repeatedly complain about? Check your profit and loss statement — which line items grew faster than revenue?

2 Identify Your Top Three Time-Sinks

List the top three tasks that do *not* require deep human expertise but consume hours every week. For most UK SMEs, these fall into one of three categories: **customer communication, content creation, or financial administration**. Quantify the cost — e.g. "3 staff × 2 hours/day × £15/hour = £90/day in wasted labour."

3 Select ONE Priority Use Case

Pick the single highest-impact bottleneck and commit to solving it first. Resist the temptation to fix everything at once. The most successful SMEs focus on 1-2 high-impact use cases rather than spreading effort across multiple initiatives.

4 Define Your Success Metric

Write down how you will know it has worked. Be specific: "Reduce time spent on proposal writing from 4 hours to 1 hour per week." Vague success metrics are one of the leading causes of abandoned AI projects. Implement tracking for both costs and benefits from day one.



Phase 2: *Prepare & Protect*

Weeks 2-4 | Cost: Primarily Internal Time; Legal Review ~£300-£800 if using a solicitor

Before deploying any AI tool, you must prepare your data, your team, and your legal framework. Skipping this phase creates compliance risk and poor AI output quality.

Data Preparation Steps

- **Map your data sources:** List every system that holds business data — CRM, accounting software, email, spreadsheets
- **Identify sensitive data:** Flag any data containing personal information (customers, employees) that falls under UK GDPR
- **Clean before you connect:** Resolve duplicate records, outdated entries, and inconsistent formats. Poor data quality affects 67% of UK businesses — AI will amplify the mess if you don't fix it first
- **Establish a single source of truth:** The goal is one central data system, not fragmented spreadsheets across departments

Legal & Compliance Essentials

- **UK GDPR compliance:** The ICO has pledged to scrutinise organisations using generative AI. You must ensure any AI tool you use has a signed Data Processing Agreement (DPA)
- **Data Use and Access Act 2025 (DUAA):** Passed June 2025, this legislation provides greater flexibility for automated decision-making while maintaining strong privacy standards
- **Data residency:** Confirm where AI data is processed — preferably in UK or EU-based data centres
- **Write an AI Policy:** A simple internal document guiding staff on what data can and cannot be entered into AI tools. This is free to create and essential for governance
- **Business tiers only:** Free AI tiers may use your data for model training. Always use business or enterprise tiers for client data



Critical Reminder: Do not paste client data, financial records, or employee information into the free tier of any AI tool (ChatGPT Free, Claude Free, etc.) without checking their data processing terms. Use business plans with DPAs in place.

Phase 3: *Pilot & Prove*

Weeks 3-8 | Cost: £69-£150/month for tool subscriptions

Choose one tool. Implement it properly in a small pilot group. Measure everything. This is where you build the internal evidence base that will win over sceptical colleagues and justify further investment.

Step 1 – Choose the Right Tool for Your Use Case

Do not choose a tool and then find a use case for it. Match the tool to the problem you identified in Phase 1:

- **Content/writing tasks** (proposals, emails, social posts): ChatGPT Plus — **£16/month per user**
- **Long-form analysis, contracts, documents:** Claude Pro — **£16/month per user**
- **Microsoft 365 workflow automation** (if already on M365): Microsoft 365 Copilot — **£13.80/user/month** (promotional rate until June 2026, rising to £16.10)
- **Google Workspace users:** Gemini is bundled into Google Workspace Business Standard at **£11.80/user/month** — no additional AI cost
- **Workflow automation between apps:** Make.com — **Free tier available; Pro from ~£9/month**
- **Writing quality & tone:** Grammarly — **Free tier covers basics; Business from £12/user/month**

Step 2 – Run a Controlled Pilot

Select 2-3 team members (not the most resistant, not the most enthusiastic — pick pragmatic mid-adopters). Run the pilot for four weeks on the single use case you defined. Do not roll out company-wide yet — this is critical. Measure weekly: time saved, errors reduced, output quality.

Step 3 – Document and Present Results

At the end of the pilot, compile your findings into a simple one-page summary. Use real numbers: "We saved X hours per week at £Y per hour = £Z saved per month, against a £W tool cost." If you saved 15 hours/week at £40/hour, that is £600/week — a £2,400/month return on a £71/month investment. This evidence will be essential for Phase 5 scale-up approval.



The *Starter AI Stack* for UK SMEs

For 90% of UK SMEs, pre-built off-the-shelf tools configured correctly deliver sufficient ROI without bespoke development. Here is the recommended starter stack:



ChatGPT Team

Cost: ~£25/user/month

Best for: Drafting emails, writing proposals, summarising documents, brainstorming, generating marketing copy. Replaces 5–10 hours/week of repetitive writing tasks. Data privacy controls included. GPT-4o access for the whole team.



Notion AI

Cost: ~£8/user/month (as add-on to Notion Plus)

Best for: Creating an AI-powered internal knowledge base, drafting SOPs, meeting notes, and team documentation. Reduces time spent searching for information internally and onboarding new staff.



Make.com

Cost: Free tier available; Core plan ~£9/month

Best for: Automating repetitive data entry and routing between apps (e.g. moving data from a form to your CRM to a spreadsheet automatically). 1,000+ app integrations. No coding required. Automates 3–7 hours/week of manual data tasks.



Fireflies.ai

Cost: Free tier; Pro plan ~£8/user/month

Best for: Automatically recording, transcribing, and summarising meetings. Includes a Data Processing Agreement for UK GDPR compliance. Eliminates manual note-taking and generates action items instantly after every call.



Total Starter Stack Cost: Approximately £42–£69/month for a single user, or **£150–£250/month** for a team of five — delivering estimated savings of 15–20 hours per week in repetitive tasks.

Choosing Your *Core AI Platform* – A UK SME Decision Guide

The most important AI platform decision for most UK SMEs is which ecosystem to build upon. Here is an objective comparison based on UK pricing and business fit:

Platform	UK Cost (ex VAT)	Best For	GDPR/Data Residency	Key Limitation
Microsoft 365 Copilot	£13.80–£16.10/user/month (add-on to M365)	Teams already using Outlook, Teams, Excel, Word	Strong — UK data residency available; data not used for training	Requires existing M365 Business Standard+ licence; price rising July 2026
Google Workspace + Gemini	£11.80/user/month (Gemini bundled)	Google Workspace users; best value AI bundle	Good — EU/UK data centres available	Advanced AI features require paid add-on from March 2026
ChatGPT Plus / Team	£16/month (Plus) or ~£25/user/month (Team)	General tasks, content creation, research, flexibility	Business/Team tiers only; free tier may use data for training	Does not integrate with your files/emails without manual upload
Claude Pro	£16/month per user	Long document analysis, contracts, structured reasoning	Business plan required for GDPR compliance	Less versatile than ChatGPT for general tasks

 **Recommendation:** If your team uses Microsoft 365, add Copilot at the promotional rate before June 2026. If you use Google Workspace, Gemini is already included — invest the saving in proper training. For standalone AI tasks, start with ChatGPT Plus.

Phase 4: *Train & Adopt*

Months 2-3 | Cost: £500-£3,000 depending on approach

Technology without adoption is just an expensive subscription. Research consistently shows organisations see dramatically better adoption rates when they invest in proper enablement — not just tool access. Individual team members require 4-16 weeks to become genuinely productive with AI tools.

1 Appoint an Internal AI Champion

Identify one enthusiastic, credible team member per department to lead AI adoption. They do not need to be technical. They need to be respected colleagues who will share wins, answer basic questions, and normalise daily AI use. This role costs nothing — it is a re-allocation of existing time, not a new hire. Budget 2-4 hours per week for this person.

2 Deliver Structured Training — Not Just Tool Access

Do not simply share a login and expect adoption. Run a 90-minute workshop per team covering: what the tool does, what it does NOT do, GDPR rules (what data can and cannot be entered), 3 specific use cases relevant to their role, and hands-on practice. Options:

- **DIY internal training:** Free — use vendor resources (Microsoft, OpenAI, Google all provide free learning paths)
- **Online AI courses (e.g. LinkedIn Learning, Coursera):** £25-£40/user/month for platform access
- **External AI trainer / workshop:** £500-£2,000 for a half-day workshop for up to 20 staff
- **Government-funded support:** Check eligibility for Made Smarter (up to £10,000 matched funding for manufacturers) and local Growth Hub digital adoption grants

3 Manage the "J-Curve" Productivity Dip

Expect an initial productivity dip as teams learn new workflows — lasting 3-6 weeks. This is normal and temporary. Warn your team in advance. Celebrate early wins publicly, no matter how small. Track time-saved metrics weekly to demonstrate progress. The dip is followed by measurable performance improvements for those who persist.

4 Prompt Engineering: The Core Skill

The quality of AI output is directly proportional to the quality of the instruction given ("the prompt"). Train every user on basic prompt engineering: be specific, provide context, specify the format you want, and iterate. Poor prompting is the single biggest reason staff give up on AI tools after initial trials. Dedicate at least 30 minutes of training to this skill alone.



Prompt Engineering: *The CRAFT Framework*

The difference between a useful AI response and a useless one is almost always the quality of the prompt. Train your team on this simple framework for writing effective prompts with any AI tool:

1

C – Context

Tell the AI who you are and what situation you are in. *"I am the marketing manager for a 15-person UK accountancy firm targeting small business owners..."*

2

R – Role

Assign the AI a role. *"Act as an experienced copywriter specialising in professional services content."* This dramatically improves output quality and tone.

3

A – Action

State exactly what you want. Be specific. *"Write a 200-word LinkedIn post announcing our new payroll service. Use a confident, helpful tone. Avoid jargon."*

4

F – Format

Specify the output format. *"Structure as: opening hook, 3 bullet benefits, call to action. Include 3 relevant hashtags."*

5

T – Tone

Define the voice. *"Write in plain British English, professional but approachable. Avoid American spellings."* Always request British English to maintain brand consistency.



Practice Tip: Print the CRAFT framework as a desk reference card for every team member. After two weeks of daily use, these elements become instinctive and prompting speed increases dramatically.

AI Use Cases by *Business Function*

Once your pilot proves value, expand methodically by function. Here are the highest-impact use cases for UK SMEs, organised by department, with realistic time savings:

Marketing & Communications

- Draft email campaigns, newsletters, and social media content
- Generate multiple variations of ad copy for A/B testing
- Write blog posts and website copy from bullet-point briefs
- Repurpose long content into short social posts
- Research competitor messaging and market trends

Estimated saving: 4–8 hours/week

Tools: ChatGPT Plus (£16/month), Canva Pro with AI (£99/year)

Sales & Business Development

- Draft personalised follow-up emails and proposals
- Summarise prospect research before calls
- Generate objection-handling scripts
- Create pitch decks from rough briefs
- Analyse CRM data to identify at-risk accounts

Estimated saving: 5–10 hours/week

Tools: ChatGPT Team (~£25/user/month), HubSpot with AI (from free)

Customer Support

- AI chatbot handling FAQs outside office hours
- Draft responses to common customer enquiries
- Summarise customer feedback for trend analysis
- Auto-generate help documentation from existing knowledge

Estimated saving: 3–6 hours/week

Tools: Tidio (from free), Intercom (from ~£29/month)

Finance & Administration

- Automate invoice processing and data entry
- Generate financial summaries from raw data
- Draft reports and board presentations
- Flag anomalies and unusual transactions
- Automate expense categorisation

Estimated saving: 3–5 hours/week

Tools: Xero with AI (from £15/month), Sage Copilot (included in Sage plans)

Operations & HR

- Draft job descriptions and interview question sets
- Summarise candidate CVs against role criteria
- Create and maintain SOPs and process documentation
- Auto-generate meeting agendas and action summaries
- Onboarding document packs for new starters

Estimated saving: 3–6 hours/week

Tools: Fireflies.ai (free tier), Notion AI (~£8/user/month)

Meetings & Productivity

- Automatic transcription and summarisation of all calls
- Extract action items and assign owners from meeting recordings
- Intelligent email triage and draft responses
- Summarise long documents and reports in seconds

Estimated saving: 2–4 hours/week

Tools: Fireflies.ai (~£8/month), Microsoft 365 Copilot (£13.80–£16.10/user/month)



Phase 5: *Scale & Sustain*

Months 3-12 | Cost: Scales with team size and ambition

Once your pilot has proved value and adoption has begun, it is time to expand intelligently. Scale only what is working — and only when it is working.

Month 3

Expand pilot tool to all relevant team members. Run second wave of training. Establish a monthly AI review meeting to share wins and issues.

Month 6

Review ROI versus initial business case. Present results to leadership with a 6-month roadmap for further expansion. Explore Make.com or Zapier workflow automation to connect tools.

Month 4-5

Introduce a second use case in an adjacent business function. Apply lessons from the first pilot — especially around data prep and prompting standards.

Month 9-12

Consider bespoke AI solutions only if off-the-shelf tools have clearly reached their limits. Invest £5,000–£20,000 in a focused custom pilot before any larger commitment.

**Scale-Up Budget Guidance:** For off-the-shelf tools, budget £150–£500/month for a team of 5–10. For custom AI development, internal tools start at £10,000–£30,000. Add HM Treasury's recommended 20–40% contingency on all project budgets depending on complexity.

UK GDPR & *AI Compliance* — Your Non-Negotiable Checklist

The ICO has confirmed it will scrutinise organisations employing generative AI. Compliance is not optional. Work through this checklist before expanding any AI deployment.

Legal & Governance

- ☐ Reviewed ICO guidance on generative AI and data protection (free — ico.org.uk)
- ☐ Created an internal AI Acceptable Use Policy (free — template available from ICO)
- ☐ Identified all AI tools in use across the business (shadow AI audit)
- ☐ Confirmed each tool has a signed Data Processing Agreement (DPA)
- ☐ Reviewed the Data Use and Access Act 2025 implications for your business
- ☐ Confirmed your AI tools do not use customer/employee data for model training
- ☐ Documented AI use in your Record of Processing Activities (ROPA)

Technical & Operational

- ☐ Verified data processing location (UK or EU data centres preferred)
- ☐ Audited user permissions — staff only access data relevant to their role
- ☐ If using Microsoft 365 Copilot: audited SharePoint permissions to prevent oversharing
- ☐ Established clear rules on what data can be entered into AI prompts
- ☐ Set up monitoring for AI-generated output quality and accuracy
- ☐ Appointed a named internal person responsible for AI governance
- ☐ Scheduled quarterly AI compliance reviews

⊗ **Key Legislation to Know:** UK GDPR, Data Use and Access Act 2025 (DUAA), and the upcoming EU AI Act (which may affect UK businesses trading with EU customers). Seek legal advice for regulated sectors (finance, legal, healthcare) — budget £300–£1,000 for an initial compliance review.

Complete UK Cost *Breakdown* by Phase

Here is a consolidated view of realistic AI implementation costs for a UK SME, broken down by phase and scenario. All figures exclude VAT.

Phase / Item	Lean (Solo/2 Users)	Typical (5–10 Users)	Growth (10–25 Users)	Notes
Phase 1: Diagnosis & Planning	Free	Free	Free	Internal time only
Phase 2: Legal/Compliance Review	Free (DIY)	£300–£500	£500–£1,000	Solicitor optional but advisable
Starter AI Tools (monthly)	£25–£45/month	£150–£300/month	£400–£800/month	Off-the-shelf subscriptions
Microsoft 365 Copilot (monthly)	£13.80–£16.10/user	£69–£161/month	£138–£402/month	Requires existing M365 licence
Staff Training (one-off)	Free (vendor resources)	£500–£1,500	£1,500–£3,000	External trainer or workshop
Custom AI Development (if needed)	N/A — use off-the-shelf	£10,000–£30,000	£30,000–£150,000	Only if off-the-shelf tools insufficient
Annual total (Year 1 estimate)	~£300–£840	~£3,500–£7,000	~£8,000–£15,000	Excludes custom development

✔ **ROI Benchmark:** Successful AI implementations deliver £3.70 return for every £1 invested. Five AI tools saving 15 hours per week at £50/hour represents £3,000/month in saved value against a £69–£300/month subscription cost.



Funding & *Support* Available to UK SMEs

Before spending your own budget, explore the significant public funding and support available specifically for UK SME digital and AI adoption. Many businesses leave this money on the table.



Made Smarter Programme

Government-backed initiative for manufacturing SMEs. Offers up to **£10,000 in matched funding** for technology adoption including AI. Also provides subsidised specialist advice. Check eligibility at madesmarter.uk — particularly valuable for production-line AI applications.



R&D Tax Credits

If your AI project involves resolving technical uncertainty — including developing custom AI tools or integrations — it may qualify for HMRC's R&D Tax Relief. SMEs can claim up to **33p back for every £1 spent** on qualifying R&D. Speak to a specialist R&D tax adviser — fees are typically contingent on success.



Innovate UK Grants

Innovate UK regularly publishes grant competitions for SMEs adopting or developing AI. Grants typically range from **£25,000 to £500,000**. Requires a project with genuine innovation content. Check ukri.org/funding regularly. SMART grants are particularly accessible for early-stage AI projects.



Local Growth Hubs

Every LEP (Local Enterprise Partnership) area in England has a Growth Hub offering **free business support**, including digital adoption advice and signposting to local grants. Scotland, Wales, and Northern Ireland have equivalent bodies. Many offer free AI readiness assessments and subsidised consultancy.



Common Mistakes *UK SMEs Make* – and How to Avoid Them

✗ Mistake 1: Automating a Broken Process

What happens: A team automates invoice processing using AI, but the invoicing process was already inconsistent and error-prone. AI amplifies the errors at machine speed.

The fix: Map and clean every workflow *before* introducing AI automation. Fix the process first, then automate it.

✗ Mistake 2: Buying Too Many Tools at Once

What happens: The business subscribes to six AI tools after attending a conference. Nobody uses most of them. Budget is wasted, staff are confused, and AI gets blamed.

The fix: Follow the "3-Tool Rule" — start with a maximum of three tools, one per identified use case. Add tools only after the previous one delivers proven ROI.

✗ Mistake 3: No Governance on What Data Enters AI

What happens: A sales executive pastes a client's confidential financial data into the free tier of ChatGPT to draft a proposal. This breaches UK GDPR and potentially voids client NDAs.

The fix: Write and communicate a clear AI Data Use Policy before any tool goes live. Reinforce in training and conduct spot-checks monthly.

✗ Mistake 4: Treating AI Output as Final

What happens: AI-generated content goes out to clients without human review. Errors, hallucinations (confidently stated inaccuracies), or off-brand tone damage customer trust.

The fix: Establish a "Human in the Loop" rule for all customer-facing content. AI drafts, humans review, approve, and send. This is not optional — it is non-negotiable.

✗ Mistake 5: Cutting Headcount Before Proving Value

What happens: A business immediately restructures roles after buying AI tools, before the tools are properly implemented. Morale collapses, remaining staff resist AI, and the restructuring creates more problems than it solves.

The fix: Position AI as a tool that removes drudgery so your team can focus on higher-value work. The businesses struggling with AI are those treating it as a cost-cutting headcount replacement.

Measuring **AI ROI** — A UK SME Scorecard

Track these metrics from day one of your pilot. Do not wait until Month 3 to start measuring — early data builds the internal business case for further investment and prevents projects from being cancelled.

Quantitative Metrics to Track Weekly

Time Saved

Hours saved per week per user on the target task. Multiply by hourly rate for £ value. Log before and after times for the same task.

Error Reduction

Number of corrections, rework requests, or complaints related to the task. Track before and after AI introduction. Even a 30% reduction in errors has significant cost impact.

Output Volume

How many tasks completed per day/week — proposals sent, emails handled, reports generated. AI typically increases throughput significantly without adding headcount.

Net Monthly Value

$(\text{Hours saved} \times \text{hourly rate}) - \text{monthly tool cost} = \text{Net Monthly AI Value}$. If this is positive after 60 days, expand. If not, review the use case or the tool — not the concept of AI.

Qualitative Indicators to Review Monthly

Staff Confidence

Are team members using the tool voluntarily? Are they recommending it to colleagues? Unsolicited adoption is the strongest signal of genuine value.

Output Quality

Is AI-assisted work rated higher, equal, or lower in quality by reviewers and clients? Run informal quarterly spot-checks. Quality should improve as prompting skills develop.

Strategic Capacity

Are team members spending more time on strategic, creative, or client-facing work as a result of AI handling routine tasks? This is the ultimate measure of AI success for an SME.

Process Improvement

Has the introduction of AI forced a useful review of underlying processes? Many SMEs report that the act of preparing for AI automation reveals process improvements they would never otherwise have made.

Sector-Specific *Quick-Start* Priorities

Whilst the five-phase framework applies to all sectors, the highest-impact starting points differ by industry. Here are the recommended first use cases by sector:

Professional Services (Legal, Accountancy, Consultancy)

Start with: Document summarisation and first-draft report writing

Tool: Claude Pro (£16/month) for long document analysis

GDPR note: Never upload real client documents to free tiers — use the API or enterprise tier with DPA in place

Retail & E-commerce

Start with: AI-generated product descriptions and customer service chatbot

Tool: ChatGPT Plus (£16/month) for content; Tidio (free-£29/month) for chatbot

Quick win: Generate 50 product descriptions in the time it previously took to write 5

Construction & Trades

Start with: Automated quote generation and site report drafting

Tool: ChatGPT Plus (£16/month) with a well-crafted quote template prompt

Quick win: Reduce quote preparation time from 2 hours to 20 minutes per job

Manufacturing

Start with: AI-powered demand forecasting and predictive maintenance alerts

Tool: Made Smarter-supported solutions (up to £10k matched funding available)

Quick win: Reduce energy costs and unplanned downtime — average 20% productivity improvement in successful UK cases

Healthcare & Social Care

Start with: Administrative note summarisation and appointment communication

Tool: NHS-approved AI tools only — check guidance at [england.nhs.uk](https://www.england.nhs.uk) before selecting any platform

GDPR note: This sector requires specialist data protection advice before any AI deployment

Education & Training

Start with: Course content creation, learner feedback responses, and assessment drafting

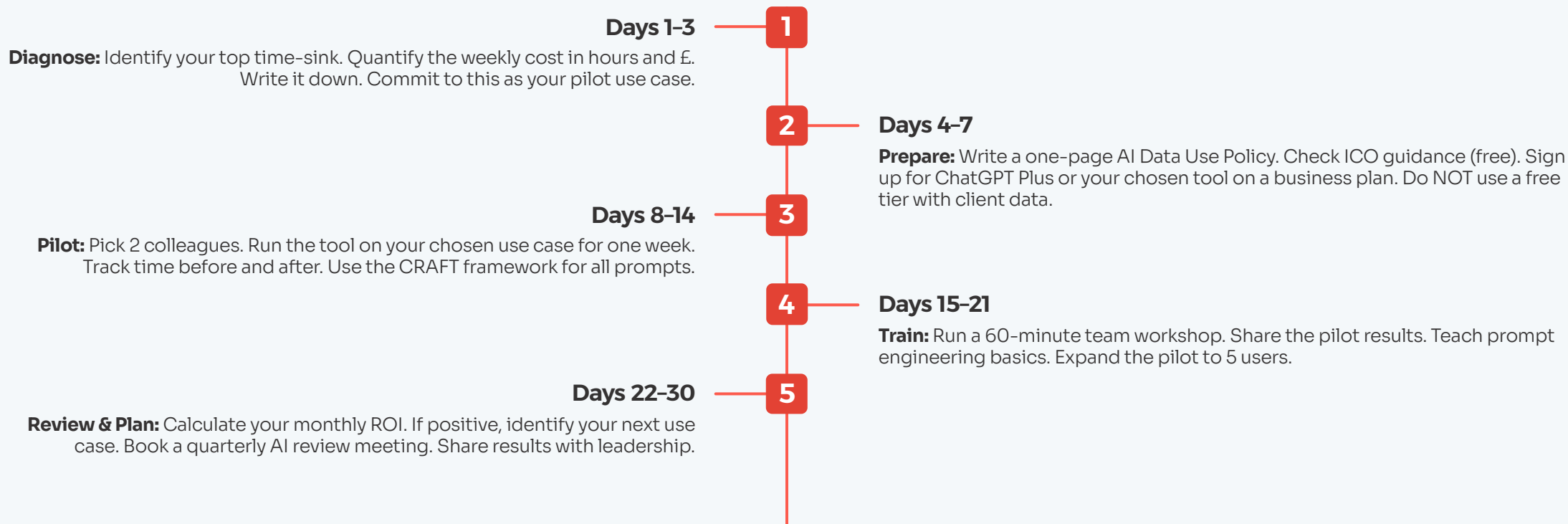
Tool: ChatGPT Plus (£16/month) or Canva Pro (£99/year) for visual materials

Quick win: Cut course material development time by 50–60% whilst improving consistency



Your *30-Day* AI Quick-Start Action Plan

Stop planning and start doing. Here is your specific 30-day action plan. Each task is achievable within a normal working week without a dedicated AI budget or technical expertise.



"The businesses succeeding with AI in 2026 are not the ones with comprehensive five-year AI strategies. They are the ones that started small, proved value quickly, and expanded from success."

✔ **Need Help Getting Started?** AcrossAI provides expert AI implementation support specifically for UK SMEs — from initial diagnosis through to full deployment and staff training. Visit www.acrossai.co.uk to book a free initial consultation.